Hannelore Brandstetter

Head of Engineering

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SUMMARY

Head of Engineering with nineteen years of experience and a track record of scaling teams from 10 to 60. I work on organisation design, engineering strategy and the relationship between technology and the business board. I am an active mentor in women-in-tech programmes and a regular speaker at engineering leadership events. I value candour, clear decisions and teams that can disagree productively.

SKILLS

Organisation design, Engineering strategy, Managing managers, Technology budgeting, Vendor negotiations, Hiring at scale, Roadmap alignment, Engineering metrics (DORA), Executive reporting, Succession planning, Change management

EXPERIENCE

Head of Engineering, Danubia Commerce 2017 – Present

- Lead 60 engineers in seven teams, supported by five engineering managers.
- Restructured into product-aligned teams, doubling release frequency while keeping change failure rate under 10%.
- Own a technology budget of €9m and renegotiated vendor contracts to save €1.1m a year.
- Partner with the CEO and CPO on the three-year technology strategy.
- Introduced engineering levels and a transparent promotion process across all teams. Report on delivery and reliability to the executive committee every month, using DORA metrics.

Engineering Manager, Wiener Digital Services 2011 – 2017

- Managed a team of 14 developers building a logistics platform.
- Introduced quarterly planning and technical debt budgeting.
- Led the migration of a monolithic order system to a modular architecture over two years.
- Hired and trained three new engineering managers.
- Negotiated service levels with two outsourcing partners and reduced external contractor spend by 20%.

Senior Developer, Alpenglow Software 2005 – 2011

- Developed C++ and Java components for telecom billing systems.
- Led a small team on a major rewrite.
- Gained experience of large release cycles and customer escalations in telecom software.
- Contributed to proposals and technical estimates for key telecom customers.
- Mentored four junior developers in design and code quality.

EDUCATION

- DI Software Engineering, Technical University of Vienna Heights (fictional) (1999 – 2005)

LANGUAGES

German (native), English (C2), Italian (B1)

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Scrum Master